Bulletin

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GOVERNANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

- **State to strengthen cybersecurity as threats surge, says Murkomen** — KBC Digital, 2 November 2026 KENYA

  Kenya's National Cybersecurity Agency Board, chaired by Martin Koyabe, was inaugurated at Harambee House. Interior Cabinet Secretary Kipchumba Murkomen directed it to build the real-time detection and response capacity of the National Cybersecurity Operations Centre. Communications Authority data put DDoS attacks at 72.16 million in the year to June 2026, up 114.3%. *Also under Cybersecurity*.

- **Sensitive Data Must Be Hosted on Secure Infrastructure – Sam George** — The Vaultz News, 2 November 2026 GHANA

  Ghana's communications minister, Sam George, spoke at the Africa Virtual Asset Summit 2026. He said providers licensed under the Virtual Asset Service Providers Act, 2025 (Act 1154) should verify customers biometrically against the NIA register. Sensitive data, he said, must sit on secure sovereign infrastructure such as G-Cloud. He put One Million Coders at more than 140,000 registered and over 10,000 trained. *Also under Digital Identity and CRVS and Data Storage*.

- **Opening Remarks by Governor Dr Johnson Pandit Asiama at the 11th Meeting of the Payment Systems Advisory Committee** — Bank of Ghana, 2 November 2026 GHANA

  Bank of Ghana Governor Johnson Pandit Asiama opened the reconstituted Payment Systems Advisory Committee on 2 November 2026. He named low GhQR adoption, no agent interoperability and growing bilateral arrangements as sources of fragmentation. He put GhIPSS volumes at about 530 million transactions worth over GH¢1.73 trillion in 2025. *Also under Digital Payments and Fintech*.

- **Draft country programme document for Comoros (2027-2030)** — UNDP / UN Executive Board, 2 November 2026 COMOROS

  UNDP has published a draft country programme document for Comoros for 2027 to 2030. It goes to the UNDP Executive Board's session of 25 to 28 January 2027. The programme includes a digital and AI accelerator, interoperability work and support for the 2026 to 2030 statistics strategy. *Also under Other GovTech and e-Gov and National statistics*.

- **Connectivité en Afrique : La 24e réunion du Fratel explore les grands défis de l'investissement public et de la régulation** — SikaFinance, 2 November 2026 GUINEA

The 24th FRATEL annual meeting met in Conakry from 28 to 30 October 2026 on the connectivity gap between cities and rural areas. A Guinean telecoms official gave the national target: fibre from 4,350 km to 10,000 km by 2030. The plan names 857 priority rural localities and a one-stop shop for infrastructure sharing. An ITU speaker said 2.2 billion people remained offline in 2025. *Also under Connectivity and Digital divides.*

Legislation and regulation

- **Sénat : examen mercredi des amendements sur la proposition de loi modifiant Code numérique** — ACP (Agence Congolaise de Presse), 2 November 2026 DRC

  The DRC Senate adopted on 31 October 2026 the joint committee report on a bill amending the 2023 digital code to protect minors online. Twenty-two senators' amendments go to the joint committee, which has 72 hours to examine them before the sitting of 4 November. Senators raised age bands for minors, access to digital content and age verification. *Also under Data protection.*

- **Cabo Verde altera regime de entrada e permanência de estrangeiros e prevê pedidos de vistos por via digital - Forbes África Lusofona** — Forbes Africa Lusófona, 2 November 2026 CAPE VERDE

  Cabo Verde's interim President promulgated the third amendment to the decree-law on the entry, stay, exit and expulsion of foreigners. Nationals of countries that need a prior visa may now apply through a digital platform. The amendment also changes the Airport Security Tax and its exemptions for the diaspora. *Also under Other GovTech and e-Gov.*

Data protection

- **National ID Deal Under Scrutiny Over Revenue, Data Security** — Liberian Observer, 2 November 2026 LIBERIA

  The Liberia Information Technology Consortium challenged the proposed US$52 million National Identification Registry concession with Austria's OeSD International GmbH. It cited a 65–35 revenue split in OeSD's favour: about US$69.5 million of a projected US$107 million in fees over ten years, against US$37.4 million for Liberia. It also raised unanswered questions on data hosting, encryption-key control and local participation. *Also under Digital Identity and CRVS and Public debate and participation in policymaking.*

- **Mozambique Advances Responsible AI in Electoral Administration to Strengthen Democratic Institutions** — United Nations Development Programme, 2 November 2026 MOZAMBIQUE

  Mozambique held its first training of trainers on artificial intelligence in electoral administration, in Macaneta from 19 to 23 October 2026, with UNDP support. Twenty-six professionals came from six institutions. They were the electoral commission, its technical secretariat, the Constitutional Council, the Supreme Court, the police and the Attorney General's office. Sessions covered cybersecurity, data protection, risk management and spotting deepfakes. *Also under AI and Training and skills.*

- **Cybercriminalité : l'APDP plaide pour une majorité numérique dans l'espace AES** — Malijet, 2 November 2026 MALI

  Mali's data protection authority, the APDP, proposed a digital age of majority for the Confederation of Sahel States. It made the proposal at Burkina Faso's second national anti-cybercrime week, held from 27 to 30 October 2026. The APDP wants a legal age for independent use of digital services written into the Confederation's texts. *Also under Regional collaboration.*

- **Cameroon Finds 3,914 Fintech Security Vulnerabilities After Earlier Audits Flagged Over 6,500** — Business in Cameroon, 2 November 2026 CAMEROON

Cameroon's ANTIC reported 3,914 security vulnerabilities across 108 audits of fintech operators, presented at the Digitise Cameroon Forum on 28 October 2026. A November 2025 announcement had counted more than 6,500 vulnerabilities in 119 audits. ANTIC has not said how many of the latest findings are critical or have been corrected. *Also under Cybersecurity and Digital Payments and Fintech.*

- **Sénat : examen mercredi des amendements sur la proposition de loi modifiant Code numérique** — ACP (Agence Congolaise de Presse), 2 November 2026 DRC

  Summarised under Legislation and regulation.

Regional collaboration

- **Smart Africa Partners with ITU to Strengthen Telecom Regulation Across Africa** — Tech Africa News, 2 November 2026 AFRICA

  Smart Africa and the ITU partnered to train African policymakers and telecom regulators in pro-competition broadband and telecommunications regulation. Through the Smart Africa Digital Academy and the ITU Academy, three accredited e-learning courses in English, French and Portuguese were released as digital public goods. The partnership aims to reach more than 3,000 policymakers. *Also under Training and skills.*

- **Cybercriminalité : l'APDP plaide pour une majorité numérique dans l'espace AES** — Malijet, 2 November 2026 MALI

  Summarised under Data protection.

Standards

- **Eswatini Standards Authority and Artificial Intelligence Center of Excellence (AICE) Africa launch AI Safety and Standards Center of Excellence** — AICE Africa and Eswatini Standards Authority (via APO Group), 2 November 2026 ESWATINI

  The Eswatini Standards Authority and AICE Africa launched an AI Safety and Standards Center of Excellence, under a partnership formalised in September 2026. It will build the authority's EswasaOne AI platform, train standards officers, auditors and regulators, and develop a proposed AI testing laboratory. A summit is planned for Mbabane in July 2027. *Also under AI and Training and skills.*

Public debate and participation in policymaking

- **Pénurie de cash : et si on payait enfin avec nos téléphones ?** — Yaga Burundi, 2 November 2026 BURUNDI

  A Yaga Burundi opinion piece argues that mobile and merchant payments could ease Burundi's cash shortage. It cites the chief executive of Banque de Crédit de Bujumbura saying in early October 2026 that banks lack liquidity. The author says high transaction fees, power cuts and habit slow adoption of BurundiPay. *Also under Digital Payments and Fintech.*

- **National ID Deal Under Scrutiny Over Revenue, Data Security** — Liberian Observer, 2 November 2026 LIBERIA

  Summarised under Data protection.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

- **Only USD 2 Billion of Africa's USD 7.9 Billion Satellite Pipeline Is Firmly Committed, New Space in Africa Report Finds** — Space in Africa, 2 November 2026 AFRICA

  Space in Africa released its African Satellite Manufacturing and Launch Market Report 2026 on 2 November. It tracks 113 satellites African operators could build and launch over the next decade, worth USD 7.94 billion. Only 21 of them, worth USD 2.00 billion, are firmly committed. Since 1998, 69 African satellites have reached orbit. None was launched from African soil. *Also under Use of satellite data and ICT Industry.*

- **Cameroon users protest poor mobile services** — ITWeb Africa, 2 November 2026 CAMEROON

  Cameroonian content creators, influencers and digital-rights campaigners organised a Friday boycott of MTN and Orange. They cite dropped calls, outages, slow internet and data bundles that deplete without clear usage tracking. ITWeb Africa said it could not verify the scale of the protest.

- **Airtel Kenya secures 100MHz 5G spectrum** — ITWeb Africa, 2 November 2026 KENYA

  ITWeb Africa reported Airtel Kenya's purchase of 100 MHz of 3500 MHz spectrum for KES8.4 billion, about US$65 million. It adds that Jamii Telecommunications has challenged the Communications Authority's 2025 spectrum pricing framework in the High Court, with Safaricom joining, and that the revised fees were suspended in April 2025. Kenya's 5G subscriptions reached 2.1 million in June 2026. *Also under ICT Industry.*

- **6 Million New Lines and Fiber Optics Doubled: NTRA Unveils Egypt"s Internet Development Roadmap** — Techno Time, 2 November 2026 EGYPT

  Egypt's telecoms regulator NTRA plans to upgrade 6 million more fixed internet lines over three years. Fibre-backed lines would then pass 90% of the fixed network. Spokesperson Mohamed Ibrahim put fixed internet users above 13 million, with more than 5.5 million lines already on fibre. He gave 38,000 cell towers, with 40,000 targeted by end-2026. He said 450 MHz has been released to mobile operators.

- **Connectivité en Afrique : La 24e réunion du Fratel explore les grands défis de l'investissement public et de la régulation** — SikaFinance, 2 November 2026 GUINEA

  Summarised under Strategies, plans and policies.

Data Storage

- **Sensitive Data Must Be Hosted on Secure Infrastructure – Sam George** — The Vaultz News, 2 November 2026 GHANA

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Cybersecurity

- **LA DCSSI LANCE SON NOUVEAU PORTAIL NUMÉRIQUE** — Direction générale du Chiffre et de la Sécurité des Systèmes d'Information (DCSSI), 2 November 2026 SENEGAL

  Senegal's cybersecurity directorate, the DCSSI, put online a new institutional portal. It incorporates the national single window for reporting cybersecurity incidents. The portal is open to administrations, businesses, organisations and citizens at jokkocyber-dcssi.sn.

- **State to strengthen cybersecurity as threats surge, says Murkomen** — KBC Digital, 2 November 2026 KENYA

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- **Cameroon Finds 3,914 Fintech Security Vulnerabilities After Earlier Audits Flagged Over 6,500** — Business in Cameroon, 2 November 2026 CAMEROON

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DPI

Data Exchange

- **Digitization in Benin: Criminal records now issued instantly and without supporting documents** — Bénin Web TV, 2 November 2026 BENIN

  Benin's Ministry of Justice and Legislation is the first ministry to apply the government's "Tell us once" directive. Since 1 November 2026 a criminal record certificate is issued instantly on service-public.bj with no supporting documents, for a fee of FCFA 1,900. The applicant's identity is checked against the personal identification number and civil-registry records. *Also under Other GovTech and e-Gov and Digital Identity and CRVS.*

Digital Identity and CRVS

- **Somalia puts Hubiye national ID verification platform into operation** — Biometric Update, 2 November 2026 SOMALIA

  Somalia's National Identification and Registration Authority announced in late October 2026 that its Hubiye ID verification platform is in operation. Service providers check credentials against the national database by one-time-password consent. Integration is free for now, though the authority says some providers may eventually pay. UNDP put Hubiye at 25 integrated services and about 1.2 million citizens in May 2026. *Also under Other GovTech and e-Gov.*

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  Summarised under Data Exchange.

Digital Payments and Fintech

- **Gambia to Enforce Tighter Monitoring on Betting Industry as Government Signs Centralized Payment Deal** — The Gambia Journal, 2 November 2026 GAMBIA

  The Gambian government signed an agreement on 30 October 2026 with InTouch Solutions Gambia for a centralised payment monitoring platform covering pooling, betting and gaming. InTouch will deploy, operate and maintain it under a Build, Operate and Transfer partnership before handover. The Gambia Revenue Authority expects better visibility of transactions and less tax evasion. *Also under Other GovTech and e-Gov.*

- **eZAR opens rand stablecoin to SA public** — ITWeb South Africa, 2 November 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

eZAR, a rand-backed stablecoin, opened to the South African public after almost a year as a pilot. It is run by eZAR Ltd, Ninety One and AVBOB Financial Services. R303 million of tokens were in circulation on 30 October 2026. Reserves sit mainly in the Ninety One Money Market Fund. The issuer states that eZAR is a crypto asset, not legal tender or a bank deposit.

- **Communiqué de MTN Mobile Money Bénin** — 24 Heures au Bénin, 2 November 2026 BENIN

  MTN Mobile Money Bénin said its interoperable e-money transactions run through the BCEAO's PI-SPI from 2 November 2026. National interoperable transfers are free up to FCFA 8,000 a day. Above that they cost 0.5%. The wallet ceiling rises from FCFA 2 million to 4 million. The cap on an interoperable transfer rises from FCFA 500,000 to 2 million.

- **Pénurie de cash : et si on payait enfin avec nos téléphones ?** — Yaga Burundi, 2 November 2026 BURUNDI

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Registries

- **INEC blames registration officers, but AI photos are the least of its worries** — TechCabal, 2 November 2026 NIGERIA

  An analysis of Nigeria's preliminary voter register, which lists more than 103 million voters against about 93 million in 2023. On 30 October 2026 the Independent National Electoral Commission's ICT director said registration officers with authorised access had entered some suspect records, including AI-generated photographs. The final register is due on 15 December 2026. *Also under AI.*

Other GovTech and e-Gov

- **Ghana : la police déploie des caméras connectées pour automatiser le contrôle routier** — wearetech.africa, 2 November 2026 GHANA

  Ghana Police's TraffiTech-GH camera enforcement system went live on 1 November 2026, starting with speeding on crash-prone routes. The Motor Traffic and Transport Department reviews offences captured by fixed, vehicle-mounted and laser devices and notifies drivers by SMS. Drivers have 14 days to pay by mobile money or card, or to contest the fine.

- **AMI - Djibouti - Assistance technique a la transformation et a la modernisation des systemes de gouvernance, de controle et de management de la cour des comptes - PAIC-GEP** — African Development Bank Group, 2 November 2026 DJIBOUTI

  The African Development Bank issued a call for expressions of interest on 2 November 2026 from firms to advise Djibouti's Cour des Comptes. The work covers internal control and risk management, and the digitisation and modernisation of its control processes and information systems. It falls under the PAIC-GEP project.

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  Summarised under Legislation and regulation.

Digitalisation

Rural digital data capture

- **FCMB and Mastercard Launch AgroPass to Expand Finance Access for Nigerian Farmers** — Tech Africa News, 2 November 2026 NIGERIA

  First City Monument Bank (FCMB) and Mastercard launched AgroPass in Lagos, built on Mastercard's Community Pass. It links Nigerian smallholder farmers to input suppliers, buyers and lenders and builds a digital record of their business activity. FCMB said it provided more than ₦364.6 billion in agricultural financing last year and supported over 196,000 smallholders. *Also under Access to services.*

Technology

AI

- **Mozambique Advances Responsible AI in Electoral Administration to Strengthen Democratic Institutions** — United Nations Development Programme, 2 November 2026 MOZAMBIQUE

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ICT Industry

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- **Airtel Kenya secures 100MHz 5G spectrum** — ITWeb Africa, 2 November 2026 KENYA

  Summarised under Connectivity.

Capacity

Training and skills

- **Unlocking Africa's AI potential: Introducing Skilling Africa with Google** — Google, 2 November 2026 AFRICA

  Google launched Skilling Africa with Google, a free continent-wide learning hub that bundles more than 15 of its training programmes. It targets 3 million people trained in digital and AI skills by 2030. The hub has offline and low-bandwidth modes and an AI study assistant.

- **Smart Africa Partners with ITU to Strengthen Telecom Regulation Across Africa** — Tech Africa News, 2 November 2026 AFRICA

  Summarised under Regional collaboration.

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- **Eswatini Standards Authority and Artificial Intelligence Center of Excellence (AICE) Africa launch AI Safety and Standards Center of Excellence** — AICE Africa and Eswatini Standards Authority (via APO Group), 2 November 2026 ESWATINI

  Summarised under Standards.

Research institutions

- **Burkina Faso : Le projet Digit OACS lancé pour analyser la transition numérique dans les universités** — leFaso.net, 2 November 2026 BURKINA FASO KENYA NIGERIA

  A four-year research project on the digital transition of university work in Burkina Faso, Kenya and Nigeria was launched in Ouagadougou on 2 November 2026. Called Digit OACS, it is led by the Africa Multiple pole of excellence at Université Joseph Ki-Zerbo. German development cooperation provides about FCFA 200 million.

Inclusion

Access to services

- **FCMB and Mastercard Launch AgroPass to Expand Finance Access for Nigerian Farmers** — Tech Africa News, 2 November 2026 NIGERIA

  Summarised under Rural digital data capture.

Digital divides

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Data

National statistics

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Use of satellite data

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  Summarised under Connectivity.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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This bulletin is produced automatically at the end of each data collection sweep but only includes items published on the day cited in the edition, and the previous day. Items published in the last month can be found on the country pages. The links to all items stored in the corpus can be found in the catalogue.

Bulletins are kept for a week — the last week's editions are listed above, each at its own dated address — and are then deleted. Older material is in the country and region news.